

# Applicability of Non-Asymptotic Optimizations in Range Filters

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## **Abstract**

We implement and evaluate Approximate Range Emptiness (ARE) filters for LSM-tree storage systems. Starting from the information-theoretically optimal construction of Goswami et al. (SODA 2015), we develop a family of practical filters that explore different hash function designs: TODO

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# Chapter 1

## Introduction

### 1.1 Notation

**General.** We denote by  $\{0, 1\}^L$  the set of all bit strings of length  $L$ .

**Sets and parameters.**

|                     |                                    |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|
| $L$                 | Key length in bits.                |
| $U = \{0, 1\}^L$    | Universe of $L$ -bit keys.         |
| $n$                 | Number of stored keys.             |
| $S \subseteq U$     | Stored key set, $ S  = n$ .        |
| $Y = U \setminus S$ | Non-keys (all points not in $S$ ). |
| $\mathcal{L}$       | Maximum query range length.        |
| $\varepsilon$       | Target false positive rate.        |

**Hash function and fingerprints.**

|                   |                                                                                    |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $h$               | Hash function $h: U \rightarrow U'$ .                                              |
| $K$               | Fingerprint length in bits, $K = \lceil \log_2(n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$ . |
| $U' = \{0, 1\}^K$ | Mapped universe.                                                                   |
| $r = 2^K$         | Mapped universe size.                                                              |
| $S' = h(S)$       | Fingerprints of stored keys.                                                       |
| $Y' = h(Y)$       | Images of non-keys under $h$ .                                                     |

**Metrics.**

|            |                                                  |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FPR</b> | False Positive Rate.                             |
| <b>BPK</b> | Bits Per Key: total filter size divided by $n$ . |

## Structures.

|            |                                                                                      |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ERE</b> | Exact Range Emptiness — zero-error range filter.                                     |
| <b>ARE</b> | Approximate Range Emptiness — range filter with one-sided error $\leq \varepsilon$ . |

## 1.2 Problem Statement

Let  $U = \{0, 1\}^L$  be a universe of  $L$ -bit keys. Given a set  $S \subseteq U$  of  $n$  keys, a maximum query range length  $\mathcal{L}$ , and a target false positive rate  $\varepsilon$ , the *range emptiness problem* asks to build a data structure that answers “ $[a, b] \cap S = \emptyset$ ?” for intervals of length  $\leq \mathcal{L}$ , with:

- **No false negatives:** if  $[a, b] \cap S \neq \emptyset$ , the answer is always “not empty”.
- **Bounded false positives:** if  $[a, b] \cap S = \emptyset$ , the answer is “not empty” with probability at most  $\varepsilon$ .

Let  $Y = U \setminus S$  denote all keys not stored in the structure.

### 1.2.1 Information-Theoretic Bounds

Goswami et al. [2015] establish the following bounds.

**Theorem 1** (Lower bound, Goswami et al. [2015, §2]). *Any data structure solving the range emptiness problem requires at least  $n(\log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) - c)$  bits for an absolute constant  $c > 0$ .*

**Remark 1.** *The lower bound is worst-case over the input: it holds for every set  $S \subseteq U$  with  $|S| = n$ , with no assumptions on the structure or distribution of  $S$ .*

**Remark 2.** *In practice, real datasets are often more regular. If the input is known to have additional structure, a data structure may use that structure to reduce the required space below the general bound.*

**Theorem 2** (Upper bound, Goswami et al. [2015, §3]). *The lower bound of Theorem 1 is achieved up to an additive  $O(n)$  term via two layers:*

1. *A locality-preserving hash (Section 4.1)  $h: U \rightarrow U'$ , where  $U' = \{0, 1\}^K$  and  $r = |U'| = 2^K$ . The hash partitions  $U$  into blocks of size  $r$ , applies an independent cyclic shift within each block, and then maps the shifted block onto  $U'$  by translation. Its pairwise collision probability is at most  $1/2^K$ .*
2. *An **Exact Range Emptiness (ERE)** (Section 2.1) structure over  $S' = h(S) \subseteq U'$ : a succinct structure with zero error and space  $n \log_2(r/n) + O(n)$  bits, which answers “ $[a', b'] \cap S' = \emptyset$ ?”.*

The resulting space is  $n \log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + O(n)$  bits, or equivalently  $\log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + O(1)$  bits per key — matching the lower bound.

The fingerprint length  $K = \lceil \log_2(n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$  controls accuracy: because each pairwise collision occurs with probability at most  $1/2^K$ , the overall error probability of the construction is bounded by  $\varepsilon \leq n\mathcal{L}/2^K$ . Thus, increasing  $K$  by one bit halves the false positive rate. After ERE compression (which subtracts  $\log_2 n$  for block indexing), the effective cost per key is  $K - \log_2 n = \log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + O(1)$

### 1.2.2 The Role of the Hash Function

The hash  $h$  projects  $U$  down to  $U'$ . Under this projection, the stored keys  $S$  map to fingerprints  $S' = h(S)$ , and the non-keys  $Y = U \setminus S$  map to  $Y' = h(Y)$ .

A false positive occurs when  $Y'$  overlaps with  $S'$ : a query point  $y \in Y$  has  $h(y) \in S'$ , so the structure cannot distinguish it from a real key. We call the pre-images of a stored fingerprint  $x' \in S'$  its **phantom points** — all keys  $y$  such that  $h(y) = x'$ . The fewer phantoms overlap with  $Y'$ , the lower the FPR.

The ideal hash would map  $S'$  and  $Y'$  to disjoint regions of  $U'$  — zero overlap, zero false positives. In practice this is impossible within the space budget, but the choice of  $h$  determines how well  $S'$  and  $Y'$  separate for a given data distribution. This motivates two directions explored in this work: alternative hash function designs (Chapter 4) and data-adaptive segmentation strategies that bypass hashing entirely on dense regions (Chapter 5).

# Chapter 2

## Exact Range Emptiness

### 2.1 Succinct Representation (SODA 2015, §3.2)

The inner layer of every approximate filter is an *Exact Range Emptiness* (ERE) structure: given a universe  $[r]$  of  $\ell = \lceil \log_2 r \rceil$ -bit keys and a set  $S' \subseteq [r]$  of  $n$  keys, it answers “ $[a, b] \cap S' = \emptyset$ ?” exactly (no false positives or false negatives). Throughout this chapter,  $S'$  denotes the input to ERE; in the ARE pipeline (Chapter 4),  $S' = h(S)$ .

#### 2.1.1 Two-Level Hierarchy

To achieve the information-theoretic minimum of  $n \log_2(r/n) + O(n)$  bits, the structure divides the universe  $[r]$  into  $n$  equal-sized blocks:

**Global level (succinct indexing).** Two bit-vectors provide  $O(1)$  navigation:

- $D_1$  (size  $n$  bits):  $D_1[i] = 1$  if block  $i$  contains at least one key.
- $D_2$  (size  $\sim 2n$  bits): an Elias–Fano [Elias, 1974, Fano, 1971] representation of block counts. Each non-empty block  $i$  contributes a 1 followed by  $n_i$  zeros. A  $\text{SELECT}_1$  /  $\text{RANK}_0$  pair maps any block index to its starting position in the data array in  $O(1)$  time.

**Local level (bit-packed suffixes).** Instead of storing full keys, only the suffix  $x \bmod (r/n)$  is stored for each key  $x$ . The suffix length is  $W = |r| - \lceil \log_2 n \rceil$  bits. All suffixes are packed into a dense `uint64` array using bit-shifts, eliminating per-element overhead.

#### 2.1.2 Local Search in Buckets

The original paper [Goswami et al., 2015] suggests a Weak Prefix Search structure (Hollow Z-Fast Trie) for  $O(1)$  worst-case local queries. We use binary search on bit-packed suffixes instead, with an adaptive fallback to linear scan for small buckets. Section 2.1.3 details why.

**Block occupancy under uniform distribution.** The structure divides the universe into  $m = 2^{\lceil \log_2 n \rceil}$  blocks; each non-empty block stores its keys’ suffixes in a packed array (a *bucket*). The expected number of keys per block is  $\lambda = n/m \in [1, 2)$ . When  $n$  is a power of two,  $m = n$  and  $\lambda = 1$  exactly. Each key falls into a uniformly random block, so the occupancy of a fixed block follows  $\text{Bin}(n, 1/m)$ , which converges to  $\text{Poisson}(\lambda)$  as  $n \rightarrow \infty$  [Mitzenmacher and Upfal, 2017, Ch. 5].

For  $\lambda = 1$ , the fraction of empty blocks converges to  $e^{-1} \approx 36.8\%$ , and the mean occupancy among non-empty blocks to  $1/(1 - e^{-1}) \approx 1.58$ .



To estimate the maximum bucket size, we use a union bound. The probability that a fixed block contains at least  $k$  keys is  $\Pr[\text{Poisson}(\lambda) \geq k] = 1 - \sum_{j=0}^{k-1} e^{-\lambda} \lambda^j / j!$  (which simplifies to  $1 - \sum_{j=0}^{k-1} e^{-1} / j!$  when  $\lambda = 1$ ). The probability that *any* of the  $m$  blocks contains  $\geq k$  keys is at most

$$\Pr[\max_i X_i \geq k] \leq m \cdot \Pr[\text{Poisson}(\lambda) \geq k].$$

The expected number of blocks with occupancy  $\geq k$  drops below 1 when  $m \cdot \Pr[\text{Poisson}(\lambda) \geq k] < 1$ . In the tables below we use  $\lambda = 1$  ( $m = n$ , powers of two). Table 2.1 shows that this threshold closely matches the measured maximum.

| $n$      | Empty (%) | Avg / non-empty | Max (meas.) | $k^*$ | $n \cdot \Pr[X \geq k^*]$ |
|----------|-----------|-----------------|-------------|-------|---------------------------|
| $2^{20}$ | 36.75     | 1.58            | 9           | 10    | 0.12                      |
| $2^{24}$ | 36.79     | 1.58            | 9           | 11    | 0.17                      |
| $2^{27}$ | 36.79     | 1.58            | 10          | 12    | 0.11                      |
| $2^{30}$ | 36.79     | 1.58            | 13          | 12    | 0.89                      |

Table 2.1: ERE bucket statistics for uniform keys with  $\lambda = 1$  ( $m = n$ ).  $k^*$  is the smallest  $k$  such that  $n \cdot \Pr[\text{Poisson}(1) \geq k] < 1$ . The measured maximum can exceed  $k^*$  (e.g.  $n = 2^{30}$ :  $\max = 13 > k^* = 12$ ) because the bound is not tight;  $n \cdot \Pr[\text{Poisson}(1) \geq 13] \approx 0.07$  at  $n = 2^{30}$  (see Table 2.2).

Table 2.2 shows how rapidly the tail probability drops with  $k$ : even at  $n = 2^{30}$ , the probability of any block containing  $\geq 20$  keys is below  $10^{-10}$ , making buckets larger than  $\sim 15$  keys virtually impossible for uniform data.

| $k$ | $\Pr[\text{Poisson}(1) \geq k]$ | $n \cdot \Pr[X \geq k], n = 2^{30}$ |
|-----|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 10  | $1.1 \times 10^{-7}$            | $1.2 \times 10^2$                   |
| 13  | $6.4 \times 10^{-11}$           | $6.8 \times 10^{-2}$                |
| 15  | $3.0 \times 10^{-13}$           | $3.2 \times 10^{-4}$                |
| 20  | $1.6 \times 10^{-19}$           | $1.7 \times 10^{-10}$               |
| 25  | $2.5 \times 10^{-26}$           | $2.6 \times 10^{-17}$               |

Table 2.2: Poisson tail probabilities for bucket occupancy ( $\lambda = 1$ ), computed via  $\Pr[X \geq k] = 1 - \sum_{j=0}^{k-1} e^{-1} / j!$ . At  $k = 13$  the expected number of such blocks across all  $n = 2^{30}$  blocks is  $\sim 0.07$  — consistent with observing  $\max = 13$  occasionally. At  $k = 20$  it is below  $10^{-10}$  even for  $n = 2^{30}$ .

**Non-uniform distributions and worst-case bounds.** For non-uniform input, the Poisson model does not apply: clustered keys concentrate in a few blocks. When ERE is used inside SODA ARE (Section 4.1), the locality-preserving hash  $h(x) = (u + x) \bmod 2^K$  (where  $u$  is a per-block constant) maps consecutive keys to consecutive hashed values, preserving local density.

However, the bucket size is always bounded by the block capacity  $2^w$ , where  $w = K - \lfloor \log_2 n \rfloor$  is the suffix length and  $K$  is the fingerprint width in bits (defined in Section 4.1). For industry-standard space budgets ( $\text{BPK} \leq 15$ ; since  $\text{BPK} \approx w + 3.2$  from Table 2.5, this gives  $w \leq 12$ ), so the maximum bucket contains at most  $2^{12} = 4096$  keys. At  $w = 12$  bits, such a worst-case bucket occupies  $4096 \times 12/8 = 6144$  bytes — well within L1 cache (typically 32–64 KB).

**Search strategy.** We implement both binary search ( $O(\log k)$ ) and linear scan ( $O(k)$ ) over bit-packed suffixes in a bucket of  $k$  keys. Benchmarks on Apple M4 Max show that linear scan is  $\sim 3\times$  faster for  $k \leq 12$  (1.3–2.7 ns vs. 5–9 ns) due to sequential prefetch, while binary search wins for  $k > 128$  (21 ns vs. 35 ns at  $k = 256$ ). The crossover is at  $k \approx 128$  and is stable across suffix widths  $w \in \{8, 11, 16, 20\}$ .

The default query uses adaptive dispatch: linear scan for buckets with  $k \leq 128$ , binary search above. The total ERE query takes  $\sim 36$  ns on Apple M4 Max (stable across  $n \in [2^{10}, 2^{20}]$  and key widths 64–512 bits), of which  $\sim 27$ –35 ns is Rank/Select overhead on  $D_1$  and  $D_2$ . Bucket search contributes at most  $\sim 9$  ns (binary,  $k = 12$ ) or  $\sim 2.7$  ns (linear,  $k = 12$ ) — roughly 7–25% of the total. This makes the choice between search strategies a micro-optimization; the key property is that even in the worst case ( $k = 2^w$ , binary search), query time grows only logarithmically.

### 2.1.3 Why Not Weak Prefix Search

Goswami et al. [2015] propose  $O(1)$  worst-case local queries via a Weak Prefix Search structure built from a Hollow Z-Fast Trie (HZFT) and Monotone Minimal Perfect Hashing (MMPH). The authors analyse these components in a word-RAM model where hash table lookups and trie navigation cost  $O(1)$ , and the space is expressed up to  $O(n)$  additive terms. This is sufficient for a theoretical result, but the hidden constants become dominant in practice.

We implemented three variants of Weak Prefix Search, collectively referred to as LERLOC (**L**ocal **E**xact **R**ange **L**OCator), differing in the trie and MMPH components used:

| Variant                          | Space (bits/key) | Query (ns), $L=64$ |
|----------------------------------|------------------|--------------------|
| LERLOC Fast (HZFT + BoomPHF)     | 179              | 1095–1466          |
| LERLOC Compact (SHZFT + BoomPHF) | 151              | 372–567            |
| LeMon-LERLOC (SHZFT + LeMonHash) | 59               | 537–762            |

Table 2.3: LERLOC variants: space and query latency on Apple M4 Max,  $n = 1024$ –32768, 64-bit keys. LeMon-LERLOC breakdown: SHZFT trie  $\sim 35$  BPK, LeMonHash MMPH  $\sim 19$  BPK, RSDic leaf bitvector  $\sim 5$  BPK. The MMPH indexes the boundary set  $P$  of the trie: 3 strings per node ( $n$  leaves  $+(n-1)$  internal), so  $|P| \leq 3(2n-1) = 6n-3$  before deduplication; empirically  $|P|/n \approx 4.3$  for  $n > 10^5$ .

The high space cost stems from three expansion factors hidden behind  $O(n)$  in the paper: (1) the SHZFT hash table stores not only  $2n-1$  true descriptors but also  $\sim 3.5n$  pseudo-descriptors required by Fat Binary Search, totalling  $\sim 5.5n$  entries at  $\sim 35$  BPK; (2) the range locator boundary set  $P$  contains 3 strings per trie node ( $\leq 6n-3$  before deduplication, empirically  $\sim 4.3n$ ); (3) the MMPH on  $P$  stores a `uint8` rank per element ( $8 \text{ bits} \times 4.3 \approx 34 \text{ BPK}$ ). These factors stack: the total “ $O(n)$  additional space” becomes  $\sim 100$  bits/key in practice (see the detailed breakdown in `locators/rloc/MEMORY_INVESTIGATION.md`).

When ERE is used inside an ARE filter, the suffix width is  $w = K - \lfloor \log_2 n \rfloor \approx \lceil \log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$  (since  $K = \lceil \log_2(n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$ ), which depends only on the range length  $\mathcal{L}$  and FPR  $\varepsilon$ , not on  $n$ . For typical parameters ( $\mathcal{L} \leq 64$ ,  $\varepsilon \geq 0.01$ ),  $w$  is 7–12 bits. The data itself costs  $w$  bits per key; even the most compact LERLOC variant (59 BPK) adds  $5$ – $8\times$  more space than the data it indexes.

Query latency is equally problematic. LERLOC replaces only the local search inside a bucket, while Rank/Select navigation on  $D_1$  and  $D_2$  ( $\sim 27$  ns) remains unchanged. Each LERLOC call descends the trie (pointer chasing through hash tables), then performs an MMPH

rank lookup — at least 370 ns for the Compact variant at  $L = 64$ . Binary search on a typical bucket of  $\sim 12$  keys takes 5–9 ns (Section 2.1.2), making LERLOC 40–110 $\times$  slower for the operation it replaces.

The root cause is that the  $O(1)$  theoretical guarantee hides large constants: each “constant-time” trie step involves hashing a variable-length prefix, probing a hash table, and following a pointer — operations that are individually cheap but accumulate across  $O(\log \log r)$  trie levels. For the small buckets that arise in practice ( $\leq 13$  keys for uniform data,  $\leq 2^w$  in general), binary search on packed suffixes is both faster and requires no additional space.

Even in an adversarial worst case — every key in a single bucket — binary search remains fast:

| $w$ (suffix bits) | Bucket size ( $2^w$ ) | Binary search (ns) |
|-------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| 12                | 4 096                 | 37                 |
| 15                | 32 768                | 48                 |
| 17                | 131 072               | 58                 |

Table 2.4: Worst-case binary search on a fully packed bucket (Apple M4 Max). At  $w = 12$  (BPK  $\approx 15$ ), the entire bucket search costs 37 ns — still 10 $\times$  faster than the best LERLOC variant.

#### 2.1.4 Space Analysis

| $\ell$ (key bits) | Suffix bits ( $ r  - \log_2 n$ ) | Metadata | Total BPK |
|-------------------|----------------------------------|----------|-----------|
| 64                | 44.07                            | 3.2      | 47.27     |
| 128               | 108.07                           | 3.2      | 111.27    |
| 256               | 236.07                           | 3.2      | 239.27    |
| 512               | 492.07                           | 3.2      | 495.27    |

Table 2.5: Measured ERE space with  $n = 10^6$  keys. Metadata ( $D_1 + D_2 + \text{rank/select indices}$ ) is constant at  $\sim 3.2$  BPK.

Space grows linearly with  $\ell$  — unavoidable for an exact structure, since it must store the information distinguishing the keys. This linear dependence motivates the move to approximate range emptiness: by storing hashed fingerprints of length  $K \approx \log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon)$  instead of full keys, the space becomes independent of the original key length  $\ell$ .

#### 2.1.5 Complexity Summary

- **Build:**  $O(n \cdot |r|)$  — a single pass over sorted keys.
- **Query:**  $O(|r|/w)$  expected (block index + binary search over  $\sim 2$  keys of  $\ell$  bits each);  $O((|r|/w) \log n)$  worst case if all keys collide in a single block. When used inside ARE with  $K$ -bit fingerprints fitting in one machine word, this reduces to  $O(1)$  expected.
- **Space:**  $n \log_2(r/n) + O(n)$  bits, matching the information-theoretic lower bound.

# Chapter 3

## Key Distributions

### 3.1 Key Distributions in Practice

The theoretical bounds of Section 1.2.1 hold for any key set. In practice, however, keys in storage systems are not arbitrary — they follow distributions shaped by the application domain. Understanding these distributions is essential for evaluating hash function designs and segmentation strategies in the following chapters.

#### 3.1.1 The Core Assumption

We assume that queries target regions of the key space where stored keys are dense, rather than arbitrary empty regions.

**Remark 3.** *This holds for most workloads, where queries reflect the application state and therefore concentrate on regions that contain data.*

This assumption has two consequences:

1. FPR in sparse regions of the key space matters less — queries rarely land there.
2. Dense regions dominate the effective FPR experienced by the application.

The SODA hash (Section 4.1) ignores this assumption entirely — it provides worst-case guarantees for any distribution. The truncation hash (Section 4.2) performs well only under uniformity. The hybrid approaches (Chapter 5) explicitly exploit it by isolating dense regions.

#### 3.1.2 Common Industrial Distributions

Keys in LSM-tree storage systems typically exhibit one or more of the following patterns:

**Sequential / near-sequential.** Auto-incrementing primary keys, monotonic timestamps, log sequence numbers. Keys are approximately evenly spaced with small gaps. The key space is dense — spread is much smaller than the universe.

**Clustered.** Keys concentrate in a few dense regions separated by large gaps. Examples:

- **User activity:** a social network stores events keyed by user ID prefix + timestamp. Active users produce dense clusters; inactive users leave gaps.

- **Geospatial data:** S2 cell IDs [Google, 2017] — a hierarchical spatial index that maps geographic coordinates to 64-bit integer keys — cluster around populated areas. Rural regions are sparse.
- **Time-partitioned data:** recent partitions are dense (active writes), older partitions are sparse (archived).

**High-entropy / uniform-like.** UUIDs, cryptographic hashes, randomly generated tokens. Keys are spread across the full key space with no exploitable structure. This is the hardest case for distribution-aware optimizations and the only case where truncation achieves its theoretical BPK.

### 3.1.3 SOSD Benchmark Datasets

For empirical evaluation, we use real-world datasets from the SOSD (Search on Sorted Data) benchmark [Marcus et al., 2020], masked to 60-bit keys:

| Dataset         | $n$ (full) | Character                                                                                                             |
|-----------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Facebook</b> | 200M       | User IDs (uint64). Highly clustered — dense regions of sequential IDs with large gaps between ID ranges.              |
| <b>Books</b>    | 200M       | ISBN sequences (uint32). Clustered by publisher prefix, near-sequential within each publisher.                        |
| <b>Wiki</b>     | 200M       | Wikipedia edit timestamps (uint64). Moderately clustered — bursts of activity during events, quieter periods between. |
| <b>OSM</b>      | 800M       | OpenStreetMap cell IDs (uint64). Geospatially clustered — dense in populated areas, sparse in oceans and deserts.     |

Table 3.1: SOSD datasets used in our evaluation. All exhibit clustering to varying degrees — none are uniform. Benchmarks in Chapter 6 use subsets of these datasets (e.g.  $n = 2^{24}$ ), masked to 60-bit keys.

### 3.1.4 Synthetic Distributions

To isolate the effect of specific distribution properties, we also generate synthetic key sets:

- **Uniform:** keys drawn uniformly from  $[0, 2^{60})$ . Average gap  $\approx 2^{60}/n$ . No clustering. Baseline for truncation-friendly data.
- **Clustered:** a mixture of Gaussian clusters with controlled parameters (number of clusters, intra-cluster spread, inter-cluster gap). Models the typical industrial pattern.

Together, the SOSD and synthetic datasets span the spectrum from highly clustered (Facebook, Books) through moderately structured (Wiki, OSM) to structureless (uniform random) — allowing us to evaluate each filter design across the range of distributions it may encounter in practice.

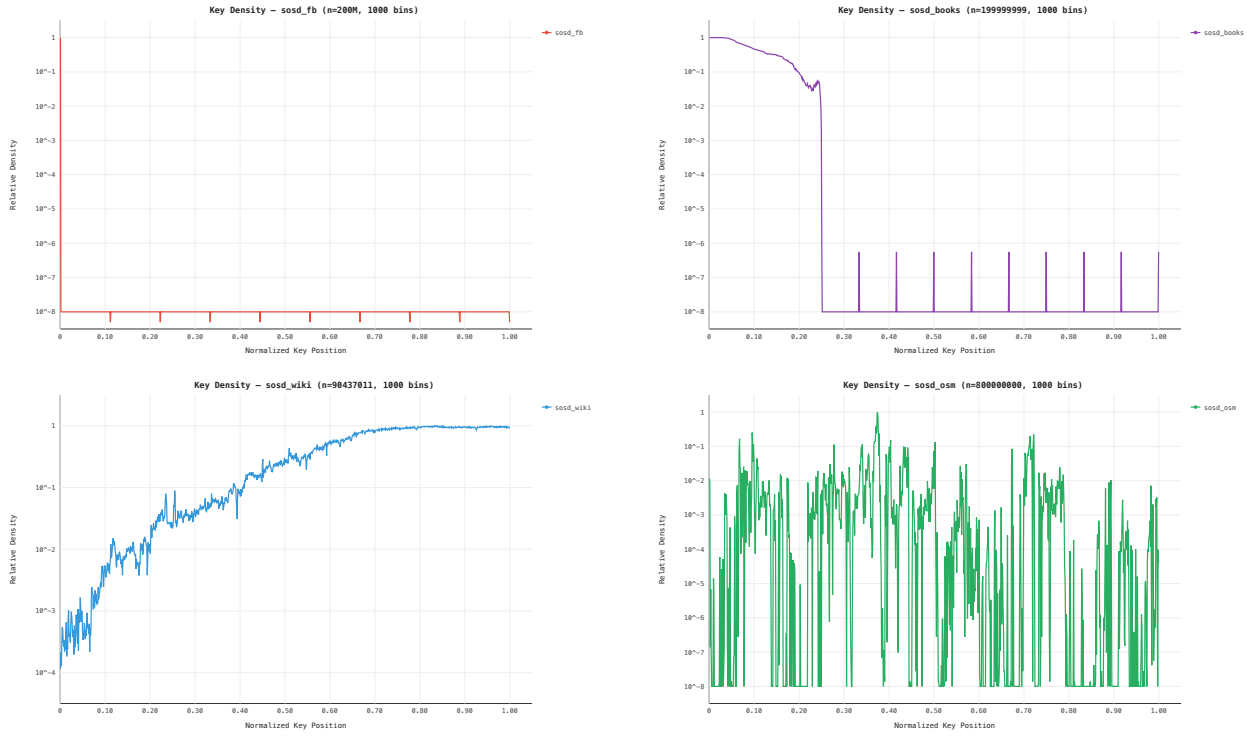


Figure 3.1: Key density histograms for SOSD datasets (1000 bins, log-scale Y-axis). Facebook and Books concentrate keys in a narrow region of the key space. Wiki shows a smooth density gradient. OSM is geospatially clustered with many empty regions.

# Chapter 4

## Hash Function Approaches

### 4.1 Pairwise-Independent Hash (SODA Baseline)

#### 4.1.1 The Hash Function

The paper's original locality-preserving hash [Goswami et al., 2015, §3.1]:

$$h(x) = (u(\lfloor x/r \rfloor) + x) \bmod r, \quad r = 2^K \quad (4.1)$$

where  $u : [U/r] \rightarrow [r]$  is drawn from a pairwise-independent family, stored as two 64-bit coefficients  $(a, b)$ .

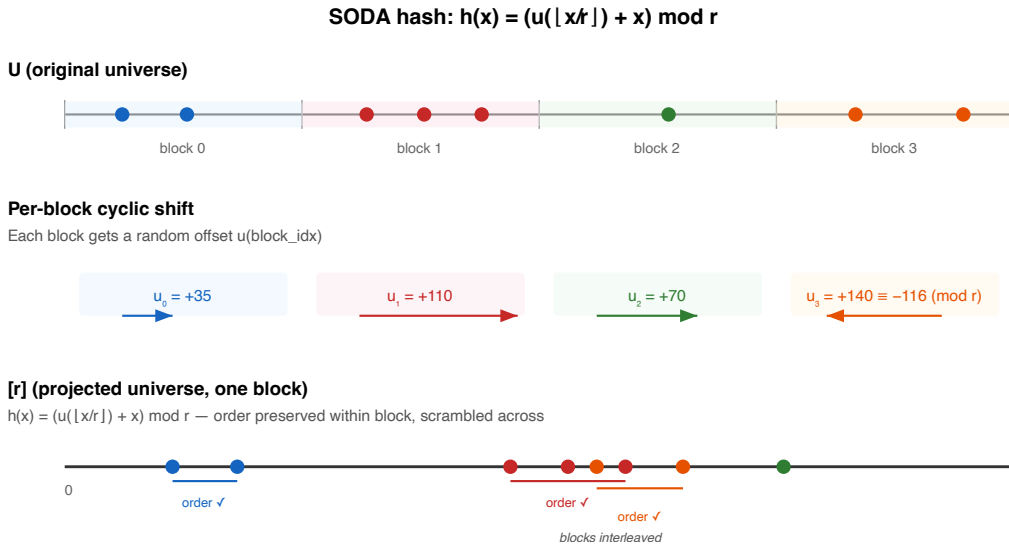


Figure 4.1: SODA hash mechanism: per-block cyclic shift maps keys to  $[0, 2^K)$ . A query range spanning two blocks produces at most two intervals in the mapped space.

Properties of the hash:

- **Pairwise-independent:**  $\Pr[h(x_1) = h(x_2)] \leq 1/r$  regardless of key structure. This holds for sequential, clustered, or adversarial data.
- **Locality-preserving:** the hash applies a per-block cyclic shift, so consecutive keys within the same block map to consecutive positions in  $[r]$ . A query range  $[a, b]$  spans at most 2 blocks, producing at most 2 intervals in the mapped space.
- **Compact:** stores only two 64-bit coefficients  $(a, b)$  —  $O(1)$  bits, independent of  $n$ .

### 4.1.2 ARE Construction With SODA Hash

This is a direct implementation of the construction from Goswami et al. [2015, §3]. The hash design, its proofs of locality-preservation and pairwise independence, and the resulting space/FPR bounds are all from the original paper — our contribution is the practical implementation.

Combining this hash with ERE (Chapter 2) yields the baseline ARE filter:

1. Divide  $U$  into blocks of size  $r = 2^K$ . Let  $\text{blockIdx}(x) = \lfloor x/r \rfloor$  be the block index of key  $x$ .
2. For each block, compute pairwise-independent shift: top  $K$  bits of  $(a \cdot \text{blockIdx}(x) + b)$ .
3. Hash each key via Equation (4.1).
4. Sort, deduplicate, build ERE over  $[0, 2^K)$ .
5. Query: hash both endpoints; cyclic shift may split the range into two intervals — check both in ERE.

#### Filter properties.

- **FPR  $\leq \varepsilon$  for any data distribution** — follows from the pairwise independence of the hash.
- **No false negatives** — follows from the locality-preserving property: all images of the query range are checked in ERE.
- **Space:**  $K = \lceil \log_2(n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$ , giving  $\text{BPK} = \log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + O(1)$  — matching the information-theoretic lower bound. Including ERE metadata ( $D_1, D_2$ ), the total cost is  $\log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + \sim 3$  bits per key.

### 4.1.3 Empirical Validation

On uniform data ( $n = 2^{18}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ ), the measured FPR-vs-BPK curve tracks the theoretical bound with a gap of  $\sim 3$  BPK (ERE overhead from  $D_1, D_2$ , Figure 4.2). On non-uniform data with closely spaced keys the gap narrows to  $\sim 1$  BPK: hash collisions among nearby keys reduce the number of unique fingerprints, making ERE more compact per key (Figure 4.3).



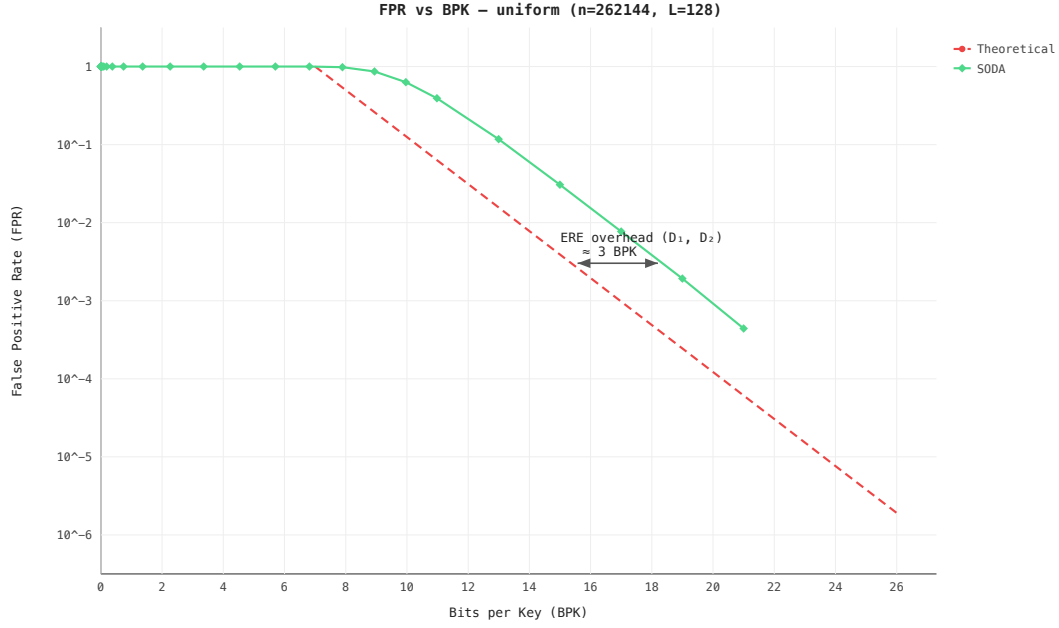


Figure 4.2: FPR vs BPK on uniform keys ( $n = 2^{18}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ ). SODA tracks the theoretical bound with  $\sim 3$  BPK overhead from ERE metadata.

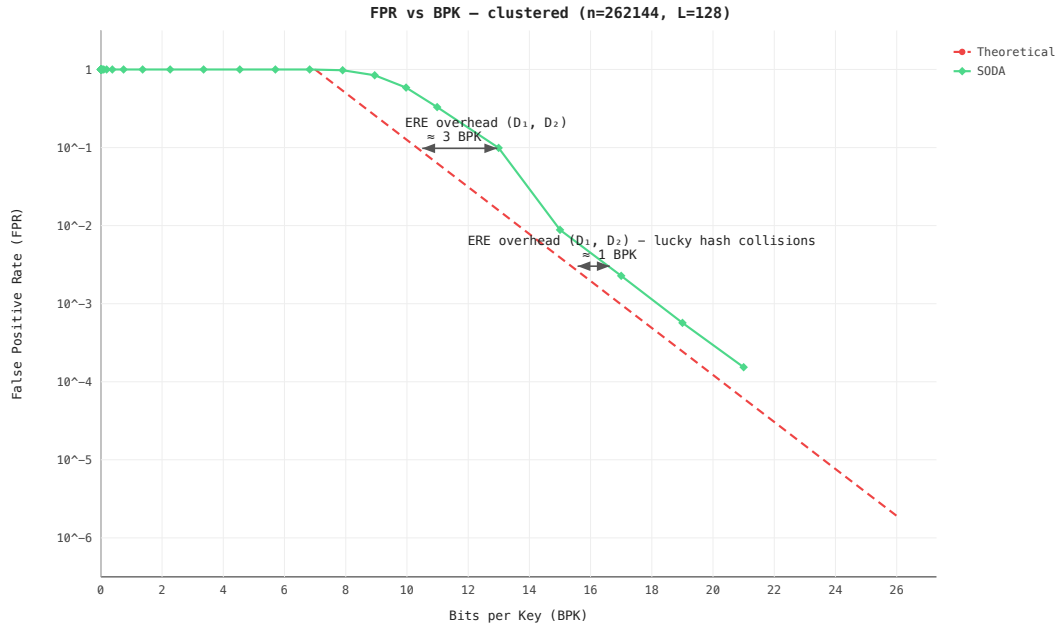


Figure 4.3: FPR vs BPK on clustered keys ( $n = 2^{18}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ ). The gap narrows to  $\sim 1$  BPK as hash collisions among nearby keys reduce the effective number of unique fingerprints.

## 4.2 Prefix Truncation

### 4.2.1 The Hash Function

An alternative locality-preserving hash:  $h(x) = \lfloor x/2^t \rfloor$ , keeping the top  $K = L - t$  bits of each key.

Properties of the hash:

- **Locality-preserving:** truncation preserves order — if  $a < b$ , then  $h(a) \leq h(b)$ . Intervals map to intervals.
- **Contiguous phantoms:** the  $2^t$  phantom points of each stored key  $x$  form an interval of length  $2^t$  in the original universe — all points sharing the same  $K$ -bit prefix. This contrasts with the SODA hash, where phantoms are scattered uniformly.
- $O(1)$  **storage:** the hash is a bit-shift — stores only the shift amount  $t$ .

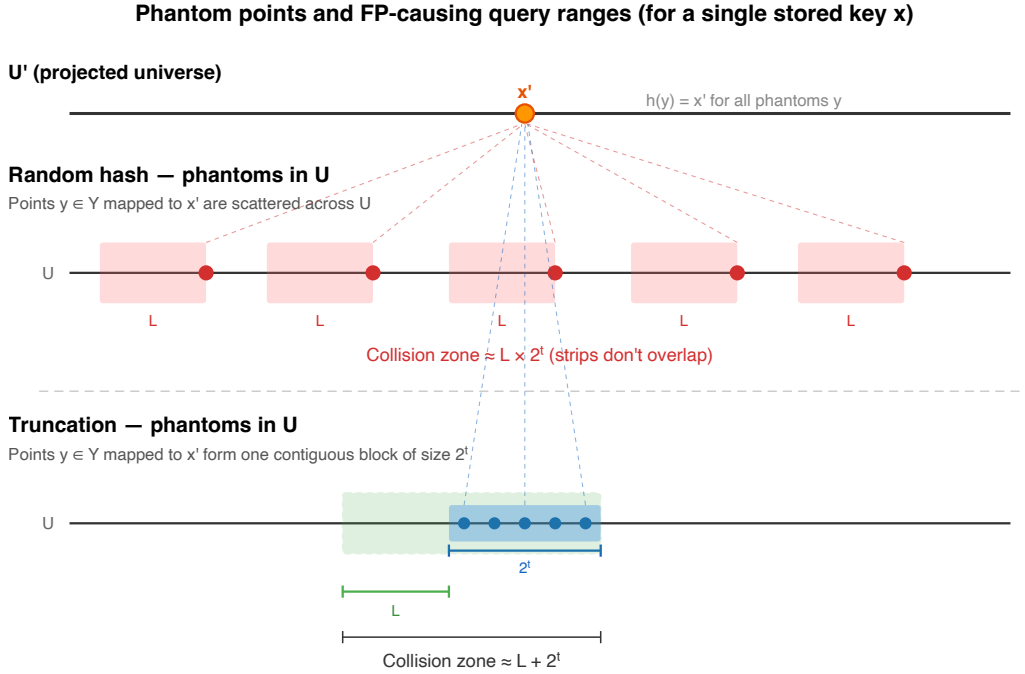


Figure 4.4: Phantom point distribution: random hash (SODA) scatters phantoms uniformly across  $U$ ; truncation concentrates them in a contiguous block adjacent to the key.

### 4.2.2 ARE Construction With Truncation

Combining truncation with ERE yields a filter where the contiguous phantom structure (Figure 4.4) changes the collision analysis:

- **SODA hash:** phantoms scattered  $\Rightarrow$  collision zone per key is  $\mathcal{L} \times 2^t$ .
- **Truncation:** phantoms contiguous  $\Rightarrow$  collision zone per key is  $\mathcal{L} + 2^t$ .

The additive (rather than multiplicative) interaction eliminates the  $\mathcal{L}$  factor from the filter's space formula:

| Hash          | Collision zone           | $K$ for $\text{FPR} \leq \varepsilon$ | Filter BPK                               |
|---------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Random (SODA) | $\mathcal{L} \times 2^t$ | $\log_2(n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon)$    | $\log_2(\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) + O(1)$ |
| Truncation    | $\mathcal{L} + 2^t$      | $\log_2(2n/\varepsilon)$              | $\log_2(1/\varepsilon) + O(1)$           |

Table 4.1: Choosing truncation over the SODA hash reduces the resulting filter’s BPK by  $\log_2(\mathcal{L})$ . At  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ , this is a saving of 7 bits per key.

### 4.2.3 The Price of Contiguity

The same property that reduces the filter’s space is also the fundamental weakness: all false positives are concentrated near stored keys. For a stored key  $x$ , its phantom block — the  $2^t$  consecutive points sharing the same  $K$ -bit prefix as  $x$  — is the only region that can produce false positives.

When inter-key gaps are smaller than the phantom size  $2^t$ , phantom intervals of neighboring keys overlap and FPR approaches 100%. This occurs with:

- **Sequential keys** ( $x, x+1, x+2, \dots$ ): every gap is covered by phantoms from both sides.
- **Clustered keys**: phantom intervals overlap, covering the cluster without gaps.

Only uniformly spread keys with gaps  $\gg 2^t$  achieve the theoretical FPR — a narrow use case (Figure 4.5). The SODA hash avoids this entirely: pairwise independence scatters phantoms uniformly, giving  $\Pr[h(x_1) = h(x_2)] \leq 1/r$  for any distribution, at the cost of  $\log_2(\mathcal{L})$  extra bits per key in the resulting filter.

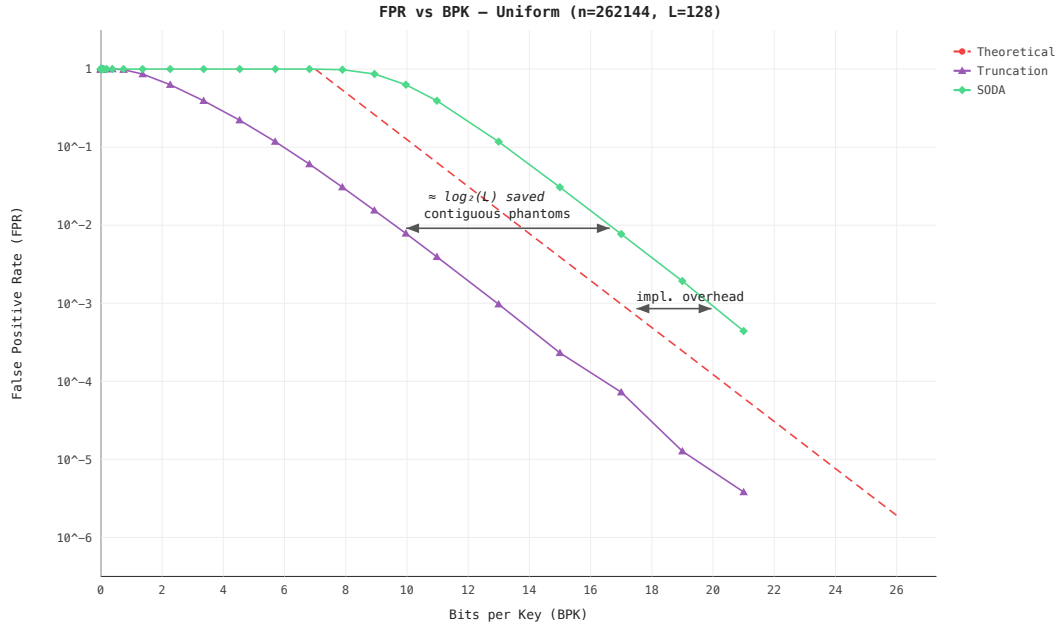


Figure 4.5: FPR vs BPK for truncation vs SODA on uniform keys ( $n = 2^{18}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ ). The SODA curve is shifted right by  $\approx \log_2(128) = 7$  BPK — matching the theoretical prediction.

## 4.3 Adaptive Filter

The adaptive filter checks at build time whether hashing is necessary at all.

### 4.3.1 Exact Mode

1. **Normalize:** subtract  $\min(S)$  from all keys, shifting the dataset to start at 0.
2. **Measure spread:**  $M = \lceil \log_2(\max(S) - \min(S)) \rceil$ .
3. **Decide:**
  - $M \leq K$ : the entire dataset fits in  $K$  bits  $\Rightarrow$  **exact mode**. Build ERE directly over normalized keys. No hash, FPR = 0.
  - $M > K$ : data too spread  $\Rightarrow$  **SODA mode**. Apply pairwise-independent hash, same filter guarantees as Section 4.1.

### 4.3.2 When Does Exact Mode Trigger?

Exact mode requires  $\max(S) - \min(S) < 2^K = n\mathcal{L}/\varepsilon$ . Rewriting in terms of density  $\rho = (n - 1)/(\max(S) - \min(S))$ :

$$\rho > \frac{\varepsilon}{\mathcal{L}} \quad (4.2)$$

or equivalently, the average gap  $\bar{g} = (\max(S) - \min(S))/(n - 1)$  must satisfy  $\bar{g} < \mathcal{L}/\varepsilon$ .

| $\mathcal{L}$ | $\varepsilon$ | Max avg gap        | Min density           |
|---------------|---------------|--------------------|-----------------------|
| 128           | $10^{-3}$     | 128,000            | $7.8 \times 10^{-6}$  |
| 128           | $10^{-6}$     | $1.28 \times 10^8$ | $7.8 \times 10^{-9}$  |
| 16            | $10^{-3}$     | 16,000             | $6.25 \times 10^{-5}$ |

Table 4.2: Exact mode threshold for typical parameters. The density requirement is extremely low — exact mode fails only when keys are scattered across a universe much wider than  $n \cdot \mathcal{L}/\varepsilon$ .

This becomes especially powerful in combination with hybrid segmentation (Chapter 5): each dense cluster is isolated into its own adaptive filter, where the local spread is small enough for exact mode, giving FPR = 0 on the dense parts of the data.

## 4.4 CDF Mapping (Experimental)

An experimental approach: use the empirical CDF of the data as the locality-preserving hash  $h$ , redistributing the FPR budget from sparse regions to dense regions.

**Status:** theoretical exploration. Benchmarks did not show practical improvement over the SODA hash or hybrid segmentation.

### 4.4.1 Motivation

The information-theoretic lower bound (Theorem 1) holds for all data and query distributions. But if queries follow approximately the same distribution as stored keys — users query ranges where data exists, not empty regions — then FPR in sparse inter-cluster gaps does not matter. If we could *move* FPR budget away from dense regions and into sparse regions, the effective FPR experienced by real queries would be lower for the same number of bits.

### 4.4.2 The Hash Function

The CDF is a monotonic function that maps keys to a near-uniform distribution (Figure 4.6):

- **Where keys are dense** (clusters): the mapped space is stretched, so the same number of non-keys is spread over a wider interval  $\Rightarrow$  fewer non-keys per unit length  $\Rightarrow$  lower local FPR.
- **Where keys are sparse** (gaps): the mapped space is compressed, non-keys pile up  $\Rightarrow$  higher local FPR. But under our assumption, queries rarely land here.

Monotonicity ( $x_1 < x_2 \Rightarrow h(x_1) \leq h(x_2)$ ) preserves range queries — intervals map to intervals.

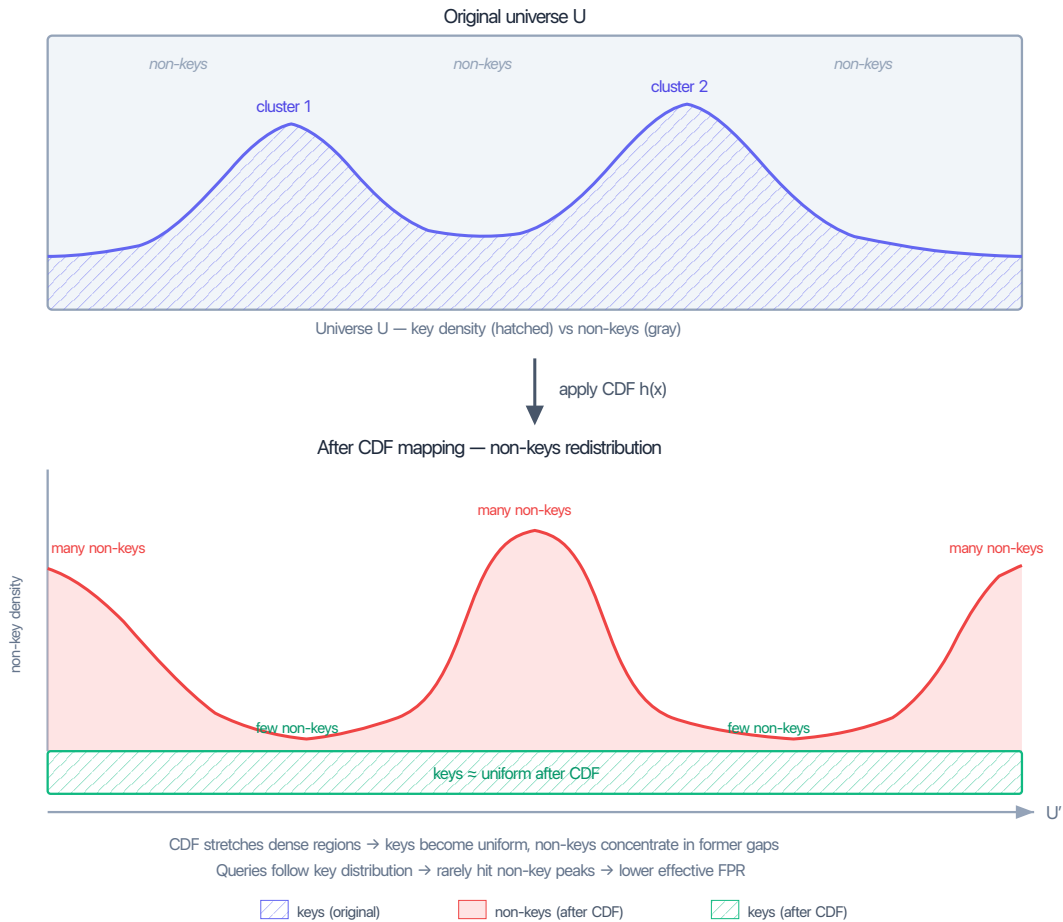


Figure 4.6: CDF redistribution. Top: original universe with non-uniform key density (uniform background + two clusters). After CDF mapping: keys become near-uniform, non-key density inverts — valleys where clusters were (low FPR), peaks where gaps were (high FPR, but queries rarely land there).

**Important caveat:** because the CDF maps everything monotonically, keys and non-keys are still interleaved in  $U'$  — there is no strict separation. The FPR reduction is not formally bounded and depends entirely on the query distribution matching the data distribution.

### 4.4.3 ARE Construction With CDF Hash

1. Sort input keys.

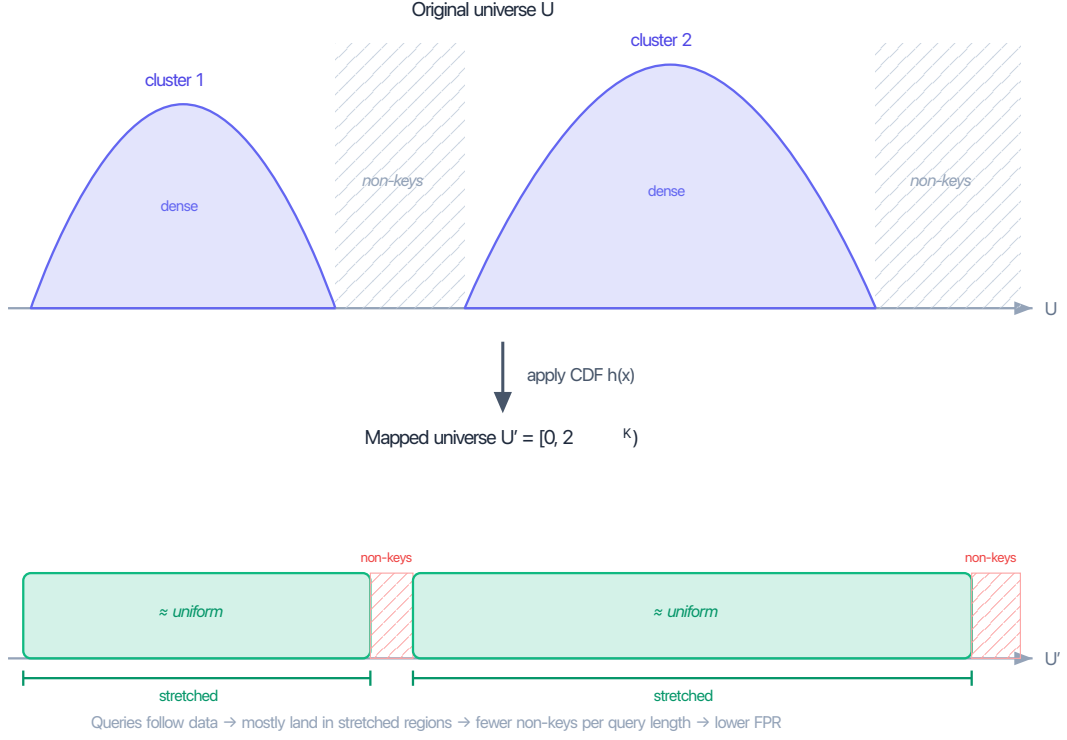


Figure 4.7: Before and after CDF mapping. Dense clusters (top) are stretched into uniform blocks (bottom); sparse gaps are compressed.

2. Build a PGM index [Ferragina and Vinciguerra, 2020] on float64-converted keys to obtain an approximate CDF.
3. Fix monotonicity (PGM positions may be non-monotone due to float64 rounding) via running max.
4. Sample CDF control points every `pgmEpsilon` keys  $\Rightarrow$  piecewise-linear model.
5. Compute  $L_{\text{eff}}$ : the effective range length after CDF distortion. A query of length  $\mathcal{L}$  maps to a range of variable width depending on the local CDF slope, bounded by  $L_{\text{eff}} = \mathcal{L} \times \max_{\text{segment}} \text{density}$ .
6. Set  $K = \lceil \log_2(n \cdot L_{\text{eff}}/\epsilon) \rceil$ .
7. Map keys through the piecewise-linear CDF, deduplicate, build ERE.
8. Query: map both endpoints through the same CDF, forward to ERE.

CDF model cost: each control point stores a (key, rank) pair = 128 bits. With `pgmEpsilon` = 128:  $\approx n/128$  points  $\approx 1$  bit per key.

#### 4.4.4 Limitations

- $O(n^2)$  build time due to PGM convex hull construction; constructor returns error for  $n > 2^{20}$ .
- Float64 precision loss for keys  $> 2^{53}$ .
- FPR is not formally bounded — depends on query/data distribution match.
- CDF model overhead adds 1–2 BPK on top of ERE storage.

### 4.4.5 Experimental Results

Benchmarks against the SODA hash showed that CDF-ARE does not provide a consistent practical advantage:

- When query distribution matches data: CDF-ARE uses fewer bits per key, but FPR is comparable or worse due to  $L_{\text{eff}}$  amplification in dense regions.
- When query distribution diverges from data: FPR degrades catastrophically (40–58% at  $\sigma_{\text{query}} = 4 \times \sigma_{\text{data}}$ ).
- The  $O(n^2)$  build cost makes it impractical for large datasets.

Hybrid segmentation (Chapter 5) achieves a similar goal — exploiting clustering — more effectively via segmentation and exact mode, without the CDF overhead.

# Chapter 5

## Hybrid Segmentation

A single global filter must handle the entire key space — if the spread exceeds  $2^K$ , hashing is unavoidable and FPR is nonzero everywhere. But real-world keys are not spread uniformly: they concentrate in dense clusters separated by large gaps (Section 3.1).

The hybrid idea is to *segment* the key set: isolate each dense cluster into its own sub-filter, where the local spread is small enough for exact mode (FPR = 0, Section 4.3), and route the remaining sparse keys to a fallback filter that uses hashing. Dense regions — where most queries land — pay zero false positives; only the sparse tail incurs  $\text{FPR} \leq \varepsilon$ .

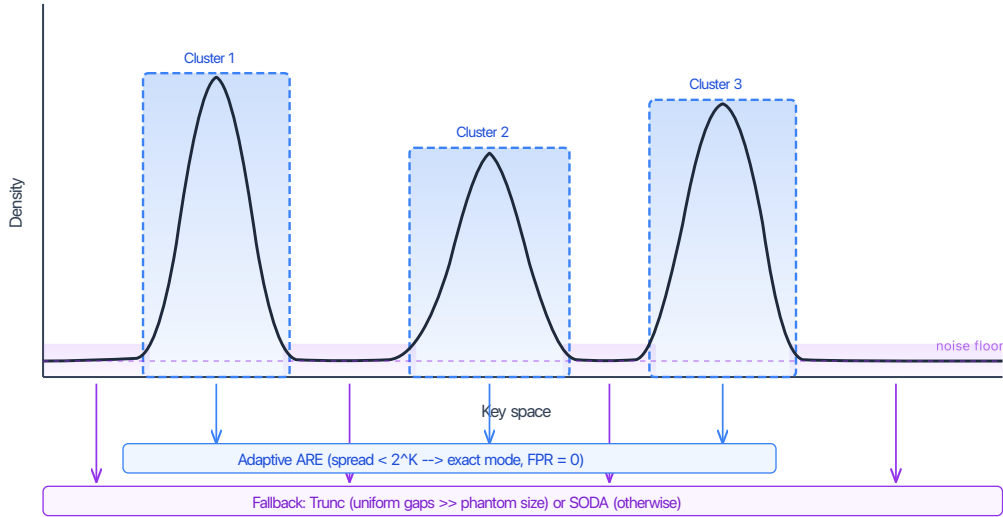


Figure 5.1: Hybrid segmentation overview: dense clusters are isolated into exact-mode sub-filters (FPR = 0), while sparse keys go to a fallback filter (truncation or SODA). The segmentation method differs between approaches — gap-percentile (Section 5.1) vs 1D DBSCAN (Section 5.2) — but the architecture is the same.

### Why Clusters Compress So Well

Real-world key distributions concentrate most keys into a few tight regions. In practice, “tight” means many keys share a long common prefix — they differ only in the last few bits. Examples include URLs with shared domain prefixes, file paths with shared directory prefixes, consecutive timestamps, and geospatial S2 cell IDs.

When a cluster is isolated into its own sub-filter, the adaptive filter sees only the local spread  $M = \lceil \log_2(\max - \min) \rceil$  of that cluster (Section 4.3). Since  $M_{\text{cluster}} \ll K$ , exact mode triggers:



no hash,  $\text{FPR} = 0$ , and the universe size shrinks to fit just the cluster’s range. The tighter the cluster, the fewer bits the ERE needs.

This is the central advantage over a single global filter: instead of one universe spanning the entire key space (where  $M > K$  forces hashing and nonzero FPR), we get many small exact universes — each with zero false positives (Figure 5.2).

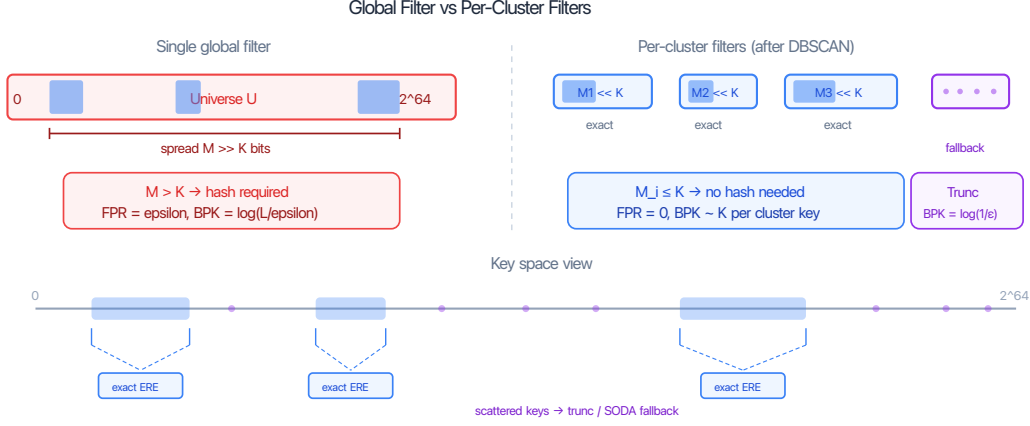


Figure 5.2: Global filter vs per-cluster exact filters. A single global universe forces hashing (nonzero FPR). Isolating each cluster into its own universe enables exact mode ( $\text{FPR} = 0$ ) with fewer bits per key.

## The Role of Segmentation

The quality of the hybrid filter depends directly on the quality of segmentation — specifically, on how well it separates keys that benefit from exact mode from those that should go to the fallback. Assigning all keys to a single cluster is trivial but useless: the spread is too large for exact mode. Conversely, creating too many small clusters wastes metadata overhead. The segmentation must find the right boundary: tight clusters where exact mode triggers (spread  $< 2^K$ ), while routing sparse outliers to a fallback filter where hashing handles them efficiently.

The rest of this chapter explores two segmentation strategies of increasing sophistication: a simple gap-percentile heuristic (Section 5.1) and a density-based 1D DBSCAN approach (Section 5.2) that addresses its limitations.

### 5.1 Gap-Percentile Segmentation

The first hybrid approach splits keys into dense clusters and sparse remainder using gap-percentile detection: large gaps between sorted keys mark cluster boundaries.

Given  $n$  sorted keys, compute gaps  $g_i = \text{key}_{i+1} - \text{key}_i$ . The 95th-percentile gap (computed via quickselect) becomes the threshold  $\tau$ . Then:

1. **Split** at every position where  $g_i > \tau$ .
2. **Filter**: segments with  $\geq 1\%$  of  $n$  keys become clusters.
3. **Fallback**: remaining keys go to a truncation filter.

Each cluster is built as an adaptive filter (Section 4.3) — if the cluster’s spread fits in  $K$  bits, exact mode triggers ( $\text{FPR} = 0$ ). Otherwise SODA mode.

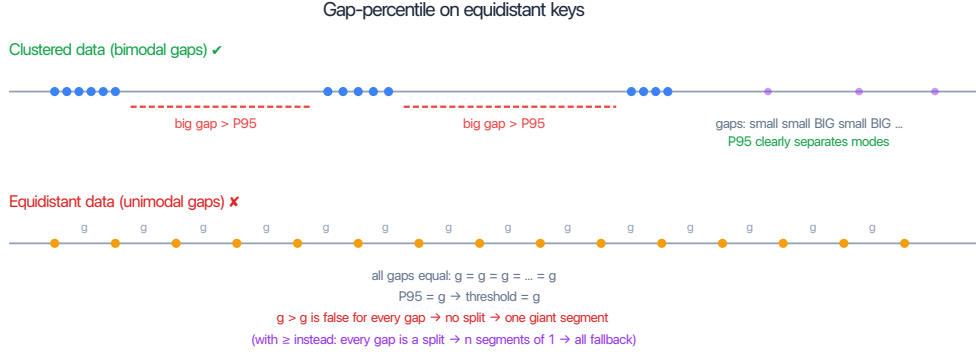


Figure 5.3: Gap-percentile failure on equidistant data: all gaps are equal, so  $P_{95}$  equals the common gap and no split points are found.

### Limitations.

- **Equidistant data:** when all gaps are equal (sequential keys), the gap distribution has a single mode — there is no “large gap” to split at. The  $P_{95}$  threshold equals the common gap, and strict inequality fails for all gaps, producing one giant segment.
- **No merging:** two adjacent small segments that together would form a valid cluster are never joined.
- **Fallback is always truncation:** if fallback keys have small gaps relative to the phantom size, truncation produces high FPR (Section 4.2.3).

## 5.2 1D DBSCAN Segmentation (Scan-ARE)

The improved hybrid addresses all three limitations above using density-based clustering.

### 5.2.1 1D DBSCAN in $O(n)$

DBSCAN [Ester et al., 1996] is normally  $O(n^2)$  due to neighbor search. On sorted 1D data, the  $\delta$ -neighborhood of any point is an interval, so the algorithm reduces to two-pointer sweeps:

1. **Forward sweep:** for each  $\text{key}[i]$ , advance the left pointer while  $\text{key}[i] - \text{key}[\text{left}] > \delta$ . If the window has  $\geq \text{minPts}$  points,  $\text{key}[i]$  is a core point.
2. **Reverse sweep:** same logic right-to-left (the forward pass only marks the rightmost points of each dense window).
3. **Core runs:** contiguous core points with  $\text{gap} \leq \delta$  form cluster cores.
4. **Merge:** adjacent cores within  $\delta$  of each other are joined.
5. **Border expansion:** non-core points within  $\delta$  of a core point (*border points*) join the nearest cluster.
6. **Post-filter:** clusters with fewer than  $\text{minClusterSize}$  keys dissolve back to fallback.

| Parameter                   | Value | Role                                      |
|-----------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------|
| <code>minPts</code>         | 10    | DBSCAN core threshold                     |
| <code>minClusterSize</code> | 256   | Post-filter: clusters below this dissolve |

Table 5.1: DBSCAN parameters. Two separate parameters — unlike classic DBSCAN which conflates core density and cluster size.

### 5.2.2 Choosing $\delta$ From Problem Parameters

$$\delta = c \cdot \frac{\mathcal{L}}{\varepsilon}, \quad c = 10 \quad (5.1)$$

From the exact mode analysis (Equation 4.2): exact mode triggers when the average gap  $< \mathcal{L}/\varepsilon$ . So  $\delta = 10 \cdot \mathcal{L}/\varepsilon$  means: regions  $10\times$  denser than the exact-mode threshold get clustered.

| Distribution                            | Typical gap    | Gap vs $\delta$ | Result          |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Cluster (internal gap $\sim 100$ )      | 100            | $\ll \delta$    | Cluster found   |
| Uniform 64-bit (avg gap $\sim 2^{44}$ ) | $\sim 10^{13}$ | $\gg \delta$    | All fallback    |
| Sequential (gap = 1000)                 | 1000           | $\ll \delta$    | One big cluster |

Table 5.2: Sanity check for  $\mathcal{L} = 128$ ,  $\varepsilon = 10^{-3}$ ,  $\delta = 1.28 \times 10^6$ . No data statistics or percentiles needed —  $\delta$  is derived purely from  $\mathcal{L}$  and  $\varepsilon$ .

### 5.2.3 Dual Fallback

Keys not assigned to any cluster go to a fallback filter. The choice between truncation and SODA is made automatically:

1. Let  $\text{spread} = \max(\text{fallback keys}) - \min(\text{fallback keys})$ . Compute phantom size:  $\text{phantom\_size} = \text{spread}/2^K$ .
2. Compute the 5th-percentile gap ( $P_5$ ) of fallback keys via quickselect.
3. If  $P_5 > \text{phantom\_size}$ : **truncation** (safe, saves  $\log_2(\mathcal{L})$  BPK).
4. If  $P_5 \leq \text{phantom\_size}$ : **adaptive/SODA** (guaranteed FPR).

### 5.2.4 Query

Clusters are sorted by  $[\min, \max]$ . For a query  $[a, b]$ :

1. Binary search over clusters intersecting  $[a, b]$  —  $O(\log C)$  where  $C$  is the number of clusters.
2. Check each intersecting cluster (typically 0–1).
3. Check the fallback filter.
4. Return “empty” only if all sub-filters agree.

### 5.2.5 FPR Guarantee

Each sub-filter independently targets  $\text{FPR} \leq \varepsilon$ . By a union bound, if a query touches at most  $C$  sub-filters, the overall  $\text{FPR} \leq C\varepsilon$ . In practice most queries touch only one sub-filter (either one cluster or just the fallback), so  $C = 1$  and  $\text{FPR} \approx \varepsilon$ .

# Chapter 6

## Experimental Evaluation

### 6.1 Benchmark Setup

All experiments use 60-bit keys from the SOSD benchmark suite [Marcus et al., 2020]: Facebook user IDs, Wikipedia edit timestamps, OpenStreetMap cell IDs, and Books ISBNs. Synthetic distributions (uniform, clustered) supplement the real-world datasets.

Competing implementations:

- **Grafit** [Boffa et al., 2024]: information-theoretically optimal range filter (SIGMOD 2024).
- **SNARF** [Vaidya et al., 2022]: learned CDF-based range filter.
- **SuRF** [Zhang et al., 2018]: succinct range filter with three variants (base, hash suffix, real suffix).
- **Bloom ARE**: trivial baseline — standard Bloom filter with  $\mathcal{L}$  point lookups per range query.

All filters are evaluated on FPR-vs-BPK tradeoff curves, measured over  $10^6$  random empty-range queries per configuration.

### 6.2 Large-Range Performance: $\mathcal{L} = 65536$

The combination of truncation-based hashing and exact-mode clusters enables handling very large range queries that would be impractical for other approaches.

At  $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ , non-hybrid filters face a fundamental problem: the fingerprint length  $K = \lceil \log_2(n \cdot \mathcal{L}/\varepsilon) \rceil$  must grow by  $\log_2(\mathcal{L}) = 16$  bits to maintain the same FPR. For SODA, this means 16 extra BPK. For Bloom,  $\mathcal{L} = 65536$  point lookups per query is impractical.

Scan-ARE sidesteps this on two levels:

**Exact clusters.** Each cluster stores its  $[\min, \max]$  bounds. If a query range  $[a, b]$  overlaps a cluster’s bounds, at least one stored key is inside  $[a, b]$  — that is a true positive, not a false positive. If  $[a, b]$  does not overlap any cluster, the cluster contributes nothing. If  $[a, b]$  falls entirely within a cluster, the sub-filter is exact (Section 4.3), so false positives are impossible. Either way, exact clusters produce zero false positives regardless of  $\mathcal{L}$ .

**Truncation fallback.** The sparse fallback uses truncation hashing (Section 4.2), where phantom points form a block adjacent to each stored key (Figure 4.4). A false positive can only occur when a query *endpoint*  $a$  or  $b$  lands inside a phantom block — if a stored key lies inside  $[a, b]$ , that is a true positive, not a false positive. Because phantoms do not scatter across the universe the way SODA phantoms do, the FPR of truncation is independent of the query range length  $\mathcal{L}$ . The fallback thus avoids the  $\log_2(\mathcal{L})$  BPK penalty that SODA-based filters must pay.

### 6.2.1 SOSD Results ( $n = 2^{24}$ , $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ )

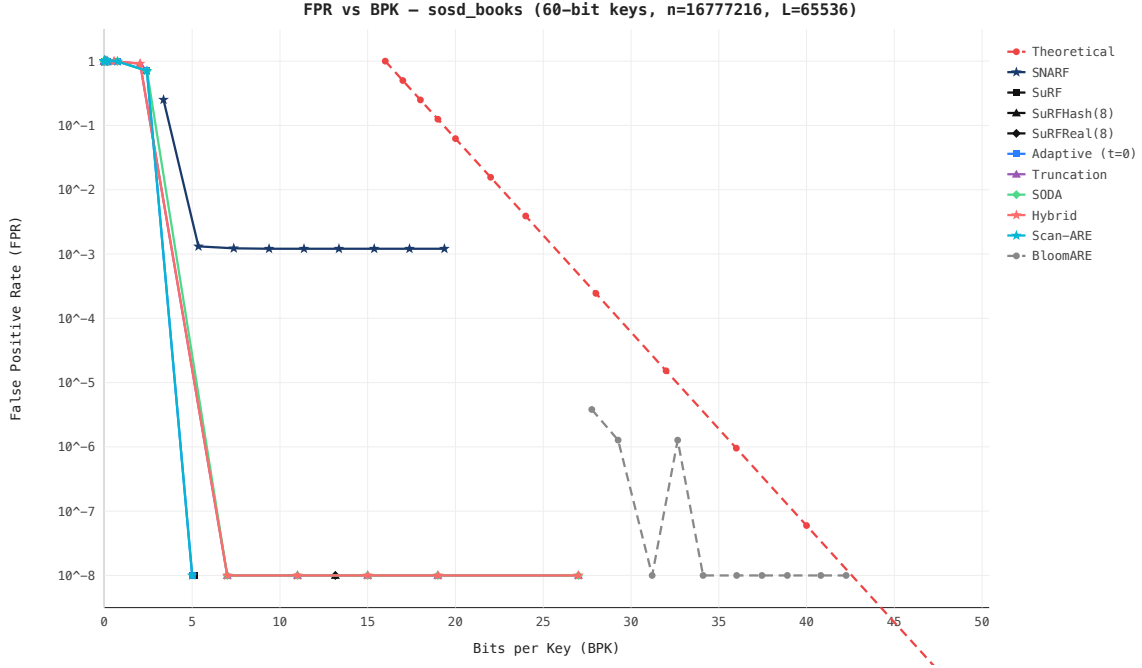


Figure 6.1: FPR vs BPK — SOSD Books (ISBN sequences, highly clustered),  $n = 2^{24}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ . Scan-ARE achieves  $\text{FPR} < 10^{-8}$  at  $\sim 5$  BPK; all non-hybrid filters degrade to  $\text{FPR} \approx 1$ .

On both datasets, Scan-ARE achieves  $\text{FPR} < 10^{-8}$  at  $\sim 5$  BPK, while Truncation, SODA, and Bloom all degrade to  $\text{FPR} \approx 1$  at comparable budgets. SNARF plateaus at  $\text{FPR} \sim 10^{-3}$ . Only Grafite remains competitive on Wiki ( $\sim 10$  BPK for  $\text{FPR} 10^{-2}$ ), but at  $2\text{--}3\times$  the space of Scan-ARE.

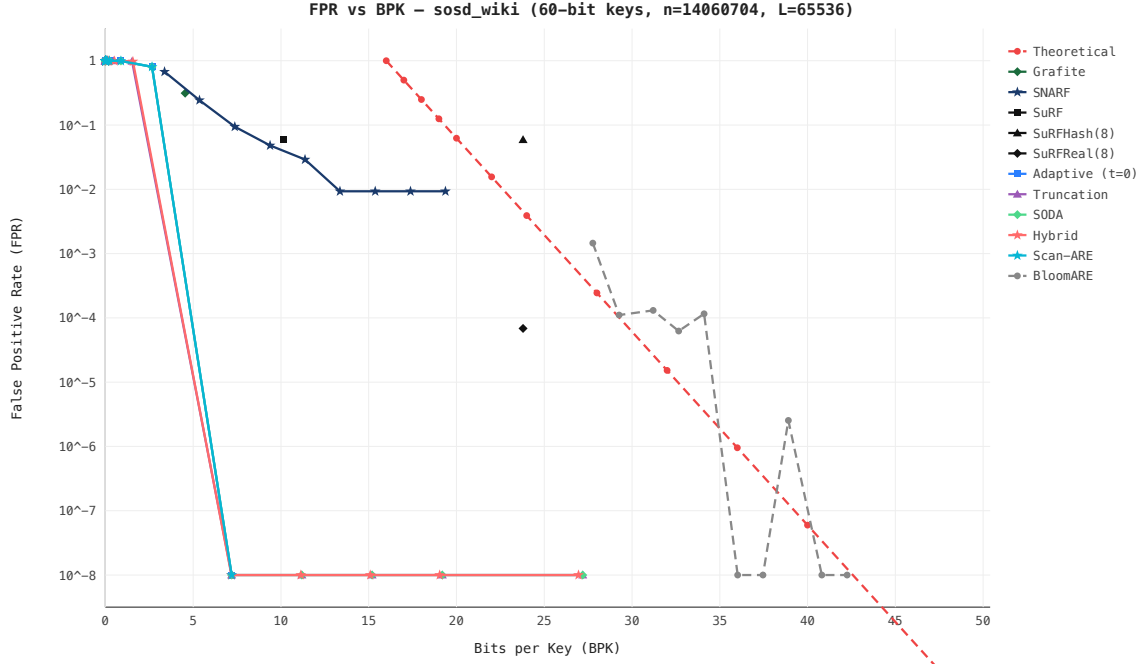


Figure 6.2: FPR vs BPK — SOSD Wiki (Wikipedia timestamps, moderately clustered),  $n = 2^{24}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ . Scan-ARE dominates; only Grafite remains competitive at  $\sim 10$  BPK but with 2–3 $\times$  more space.

### 6.3 BPK at Industry-Standard FPR Targets

In practice, storage systems target a specific FPR — typically  $10^{-2}$  or  $10^{-3}$  — and want to minimize the filter’s memory footprint. The relevant question is: how many bits per key does each filter need to reach the target FPR?

We report this metric separately for each of the 9 benchmark distributions: 4 real-world (SOSD) and 5 synthetic. Each distribution exercises different filter strengths — a filter that excels on clustered data may be mediocre on uniform, and vice versa.

#### SOSD Distributions

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafite    | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.1: BPK to reach target FPR — SOSD Facebook ( $n = 2^{24}$ , highly clustered).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.2: BPK to reach target FPR — SOSD Books ( $n = 2^{24}$ , clustered by publisher).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.3: BPK to reach target FPR — SOSD Wiki ( $n = 2^{24}$ , moderately clustered).

## Synthetic Distributions

## 6.4 Summary of Results

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.4: BPK to reach target FPR — SOSD OSM ( $n = 2^{24}$ , geospatially clustered).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.5: BPK to reach target FPR — Clustered synthetic ( $n = 2^{24}$ ).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.6: BPK to reach target FPR — Uniform synthetic ( $n = 2^{24}$ ).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.7: BPK to reach target FPR — Spread synthetic ( $n = 2^{24}$ ).



| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.8: BPK to reach target FPR — Zipfian synthetic ( $n = 2^{24}$ ).

| Filter     | $\mathcal{L} = 128$ |               | $\mathcal{L} = 65536$ |               |
|------------|---------------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|
|            | FPR $10^{-2}$       | FPR $10^{-3}$ | FPR $10^{-2}$         | FPR $10^{-3}$ |
| Scan-ARE   | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Grafit     | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SNARF      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SODA       | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Truncation | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| SuRF-Real  | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |
| Bloom      | —                   | —             | —                     | —             |

Table 6.9: BPK to reach target FPR — Temporal synthetic ( $n = 2^{24}$ ).

| Filter     | BPK ( $\mathcal{L}=65536$ ) | FPR                      | Distribution dependence  |
|------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Scan-ARE   | $\sim 5$                    | $< 10^{-8}$              | Best on clustered data   |
| Grafit     | $\sim 10$                   | $\sim 10^{-2}$           | Distribution-independent |
| SNARF      | $\sim 28$                   | $\sim 10^{-3}$           | Learned, data-dependent  |
| SODA       | $\sim 5$                    | $\approx 1$ (degenerate) | Distribution-independent |
| Truncation | $\sim 3$                    | $\approx 1$ (degenerate) | Fails on clustered data  |
| Bloom      | $\sim 30$                   | $\sim 10^{-4}$           | Distribution-independent |

Table 6.10: Comparison at  $n = 2^{24}$ ,  $\mathcal{L} = 65536$  on SOSD Books. Scan-ARE dominates the Pareto frontier by exploiting cluster density for exact-mode sub-filters.

## Chapter 7

## Conclusion

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